depleted and what addition of fertilizers should be planned accordingly.

Statement II: CORRECT—Accuracy of soil analysis is directly related to the quality of the soil sample taken. Application of appropriate fertilizers with the proper nutrient mix will help not only to increase the productivity and farm income but also provide a more realistic chance to obtain the desired yield. There are various methods for taking a soil sample from a field.

35. Statement I: INcoREcT—Indian agriculture has traditionally been dependent on monsoon rains and only about 40% of cultivable land is irrigated. Given the variability of rains in terms of their magnitude and phasing during the season, agricultural productivity is a risky activity.

    Farmers need to look for plants that are less water intensive, but this also often means the production technology is not fully developed, the crop is not supported by public procurement policy to the same extent as the main staples (most public subsidies are not applicable to rainfed agriculture), and the crops do not fetch high prices in the market.

    Statement II: CORRECT—The supply of fertilizer, pesticide, and insecticides required for rainfed agriculture need to be ensured to raise current levels of productivity. Rainfed agriculture can make up the deficit in critical areas such as pulses and oilseeds; shortages in these products are currently fueling price spikes and adding to macroeconomic vulnerabilities.

36. Statement I: CORRECT: A striking feature of the monsoon is that a high proportion of the annual rainfall takes place within two to three months, resulting in massive floods and run-offs. Except for the water that goes into charging the groundwater, the rest is wasted and hardly used for cultivation. Rainwater harvesting is at a nascent stage. Despite hundreds of research studies in support of designing and maintaining watersheds, attention has not been paid to their management. Experience in some parts of the country indicates that watershed management can have positive impact on the rabi crop and can smooth out the availability of water over the year for day-to- day use in rural areas